

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How do you communicate in the new age?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you had a job where you had to talk a lot on the phone?
- How do you deal with a difficult person on the phone?
- What device do you use to communicate with others?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can start and end a conversation on the phone.
- I can manage a phone conversation.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa **video chats*** with her father for the first time.

* "Video chat" can be a noun or a verb. It has become a popular way to talk to someone long distance.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Hi, Dad. How are you doing?
Dad: Oh, Vanessa. Am I looking at you live?
Vanessa: Yes, Dad. It's nice to see your face.
Dad: This computer video thing is neat. I'm not up with all this new technology stuff in my job.
Vanessa: It's called video chatting. We can use Internet data to transmit video on a laptop now. So ... you look pretty well.
Dad: Oh, thanks. Well, I feel up for going back to work actually. How is your job, Vanessa?
Vanessa: Well, there's been a lot of pressure managing the staff, but I'm keeping up with it. Dad, if you go home, a nurse could come over and look in on you once a week.
Lily: Then you'd be able to take walks at the park, George.
Vanessa: Listen, I have to get back to work in a bit. You should also ask the home nurse to prescribe a healthy diet, OK?
Dad: I'd better call up my boss.
Lily: Oh, George, you ought to take it easy for a while.
Vanessa: I'm sorry, but I have to go. Let's set up another call again. It's free.
Lily: You take care of yourself, sweetie.
Vanessa: You, too. I'll see you both soon. Bye.





Let's Practice!

Vanessa and her father are both thinking about work.

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Write down the correct word to correctly complete the sentence. Use: ready, get more rest, video chatting, get back to work, a challenging.

1. Vanessa's dad has not used _____ in his job.
2. Vanessa has had _____ time managing her staff.
3. Vanessa's dad feels like he is _____ to go back to work.
4. Vanessa's mother feels that her husband should _____.
5. Vanessa has to _____.



Let's Practice!

How do you end a phone call?

Instructions: Read the first part of the sentence on the left. Mark the correct box in the table to complete the sentence. There is only one answer per question.

	back to work in a bit.	of yourself.	but I have to go.	you both soon.
I'm sorry,				
I have to get				
You take care				
I'll see				





Extension Activity

Write a short phone conversation that talks about work.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a short phone conversation that asks about work. Write 8 - 10 lines.
- Set up a meeting or ask about a presentation.
- Use phrases you've learned to start the conversation and end the conversation.
- Practice this dialogue with your partner.
- After practicing a few times looking at the dialogue on the page, do it again without looking at your page.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write a dialogue that talks about work.

☐ ☐

I use proper expressions to start and end a phone conversation.

☐ ☐

I become familiarized with dialogue expressions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- live** (adjective): to see someone or something on a screen in real time
e.g. Vanessa's dad was happy to see her live while he was talking with her.
- video chat** (noun): a conversation with someone through the computer screen
e.g. While you're at the hospital, it's nice to be able to do a video chat with family members.
- data** (noun): information such as text, images or video that is sent through the Internet
e.g. Internet service is so much more advanced now that we can send a lot of data quickly.
- to transmit** (verb): to send through cable lines or through the Internet
e.g. With high speed Internet, we can now transmit images and video quickly.
- to be up with** (expression): to be updated with a certain type of information or new trend
e.g. I'm not up with all this new technology.
- neat** (adjective): interesting; fascinating
e.g. It's neat to be able to see someone live while chatting with them.
- to manage** (verb): to look after or to supervise
e.g. Vanessa has had a lot of pressure managing her staff.
- to keep up** (verb): to maintain progress or meet a standard
e.g. I'm keeping up with the demands of managing the staff.





Learning Points

On the Phone

Talking on the phone in your second language can be a challenge. In English, there are certain common polite phrases you use to start and end a conversation, especially in a business context.

Sometimes you might have limited time to be on the phone because you have work to do or you get interrupted. It's important to manage a phone conversation to suit your needs.

Here are some phrases you can use to end a phone conversation in a polite way:

I'm sorry, but I have to go.

Look, I have to get back to work. / I have something cooking on the stove. / I need to get back to my kids.

Listen, I'm running out of time. / It's getting late.

... followed by

Can we talk about this later?

It's good to start with "I'm sorry, but ..." to be apologetic about cutting the conversation short.

When you know the person well, saying "Look" or "Listen" catches the other person's attention.

Here are some phrases for starting and ending a phone call.

Receiver	Receiver	Caller
Greeting/ Inquiring	<i>Hello.</i>	<i>Hello, this is Jason. Could I speak to Aidan please?</i>
	<i>Sure. Just a moment please.</i>	<i>Thank you.</i>
Starting	<i>Hi, Jason. How are you?</i>	<i>Pretty good. How are you?</i>
Ending	<i>I'm sorry, but I have to go.</i>	<i>No problem. I'll talk to you later.</i>
End Greeting	<i>Alright. Thanks. Take care.</i>	<i>You, too. See you soon. Bye.</i>





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs about Phone Communication

A phrasal verb is a phrase formed with a verb + preposition. Some phrasal verbs are unique to communication on the phone.

Look at the following list of phrasal verbs. Try to use some of these the next time you're on the phone.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
to call up/ring up	to call and try to reach someone on the phone
to get through	to succeed in speaking to someone on the phone
to set up	to arrange another call or video chat
to hang on/to hold on	to wait for a short time
to put through	to connect a caller to someone in the office
to pick up	to answer a phone call

Examples:

- *I'd better call up my boss.*
- *Let's set up another call again.*

